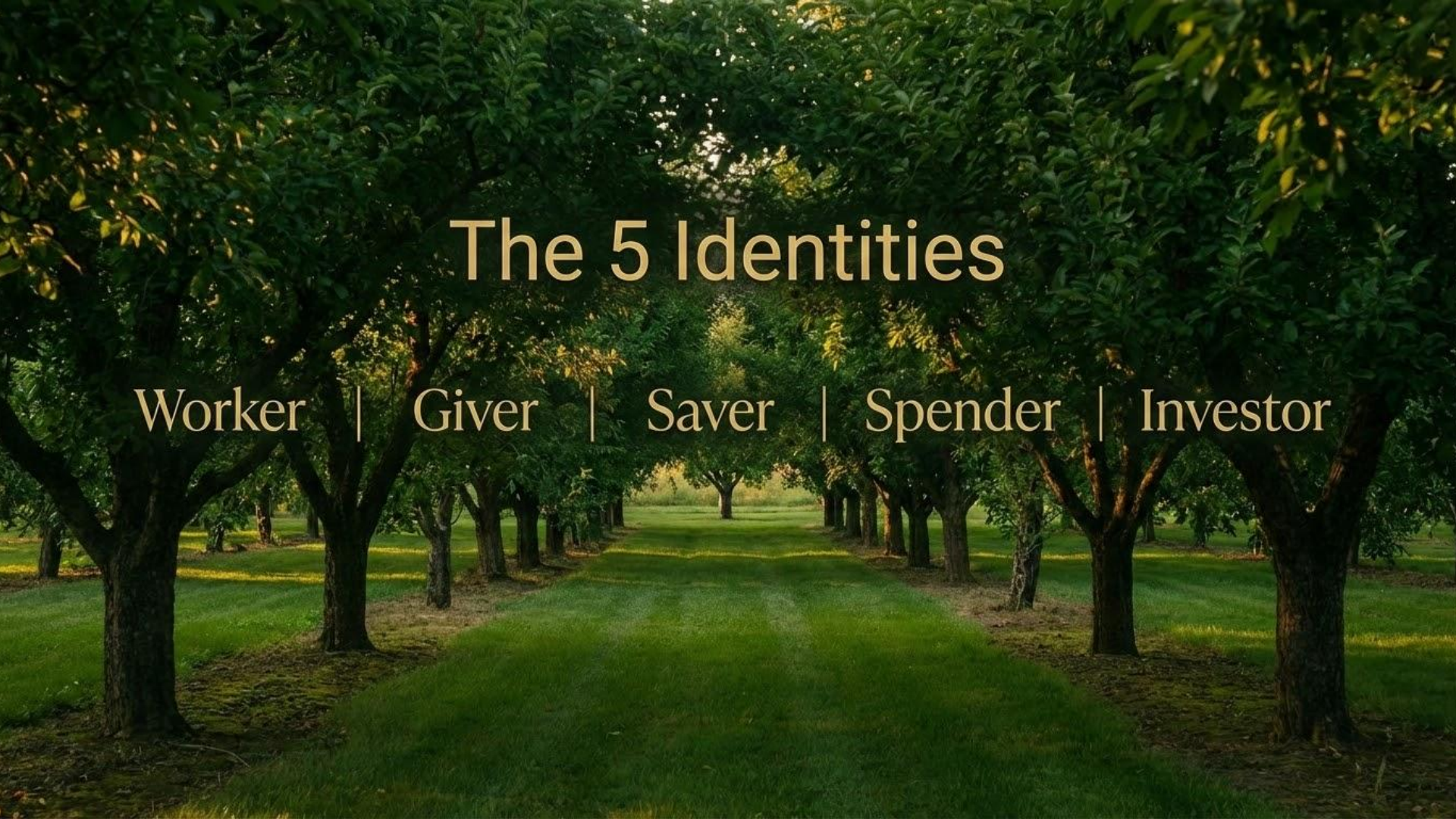
Faithful Finances

Practical Wisdom for Biblical Stewardship

A 6-Week Course on Faith, Finance, and Freedom


The 5 Identities
Worker | Giver | Saver | Spender | Investor

The Paradox

He who loves money will not be satisfied with money.

Ecclesiastes 5:10-12 (NLT)

Those who love money will never have enough. How meaningless to think that wealth brings true happiness! The more you have, the more people come to help you spend it. So what good is wealth—except perhaps to watch it slip through your fingers! People who work hard sleep well, whether they eat little or much. But the rich seldom get a good night's sleep.

Ecclesiastes 5:13-15 (NLT)

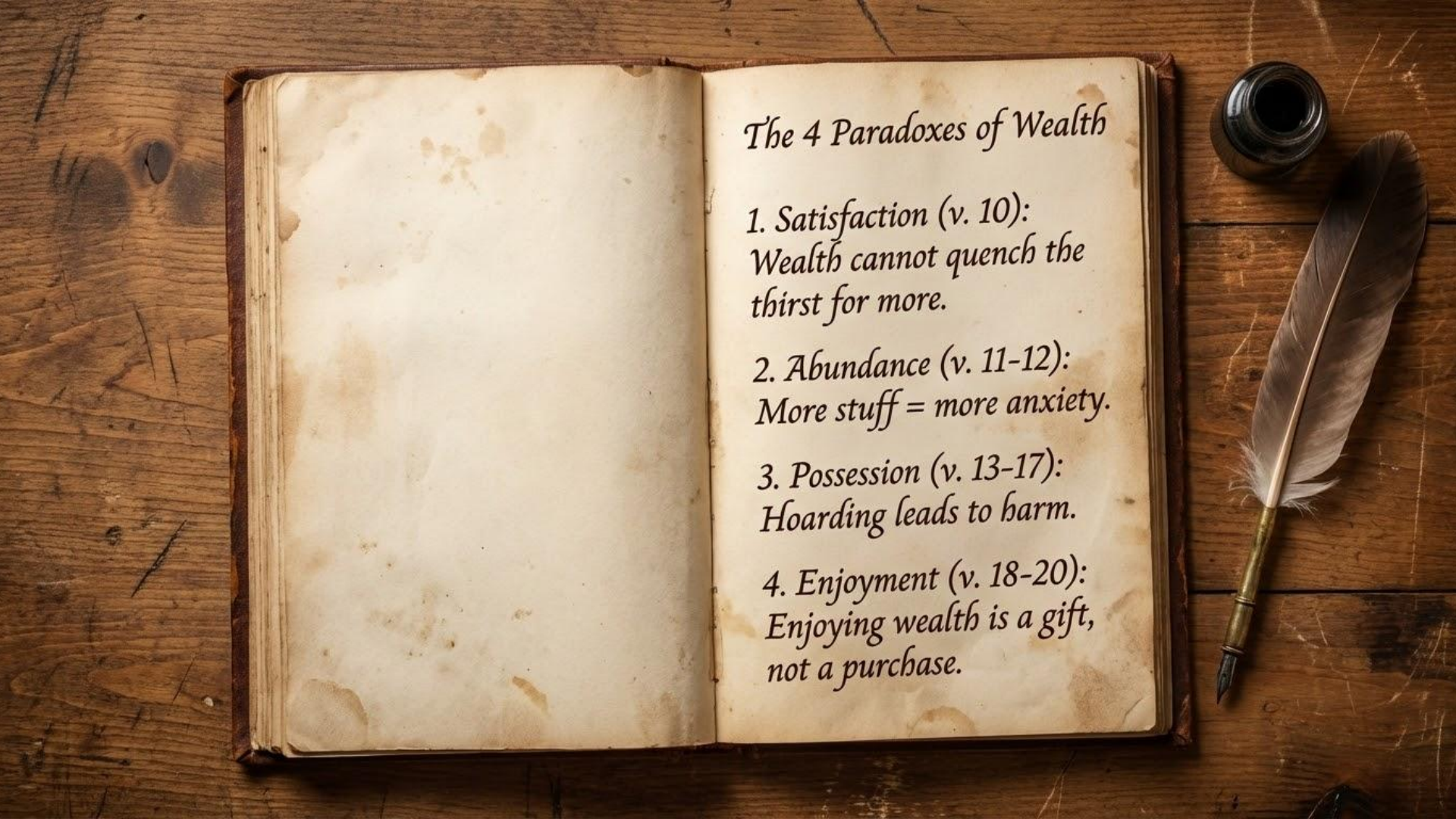
There is another serious problem I have seen under the sun. Hoarding riches harms the saver. Money is put into risky investments that turn sour, and everything is lost. In the end, there is nothing left to pass on to one's children. We all come to the end of our lives as naked and empty-handed as on the day we were born. We can't take our riches with us.

Ecclesiastes 5:16-17 (NLT)

And this, too, is a very serious problem. People take nothing with them when they die. They work hard to get nothing, just chasing the wind. Throughout their lives, they live under a cloud—frustrated, discouraged, and angry.

Ecclesiastes 5:18-20 (NLT)

Even so, I have noticed one thing, at least, that is good. It is good for people to eat, drink, and enjoy their work under the sun during the short life God has given them, and to accept their lot in life. And it is a good thing to receive wealth from God and the good health to enjoy it. To enjoy your work and accept your lot in life—this is indeed a gift from God. God keeps such people so busy enjoying life that they take no time to brood over the past.


The 4 Paradoxes of Wealth
1. Satisfaction (v. 10):
Wealth cannot quench the
thirst for more.
2. Abundance (v. 11-12):
More stuff = more anxiety.
3. Possession (v. 13-17):
Hoarding leads to harm.
4. Enjoyment (v. 18-20):
Enjoying wealth is a gift,
not a purchase.

Faithful Finances
Week 1: The Worker

Activity: Who Do You Help?

1. Introduce yourself to your neighbor.
2. Do NOT use your Job Title.
3. DO describe the problem you solve.

Colossians 3:23-24 (ESV)

Whatever you do, work heartily, as for for the Lord and not for men, knowing that from the Lord you will receive the inheritance as your reward. You are serving the Lord Christ.

CROWN

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Whatever you do, work heartily, as for for the Lord and not for men, knowing that from the Lord you will receive the inheritance as your reward. You are serving the Lord Christ.

Identity vs. Activity

There are no small jobs. Only small perspectives.

Integrity
Paint the back of the fence.
Excellence in the dark creates integrity in the light.

The Audience of One

For whom are you performing?

Designed to Work

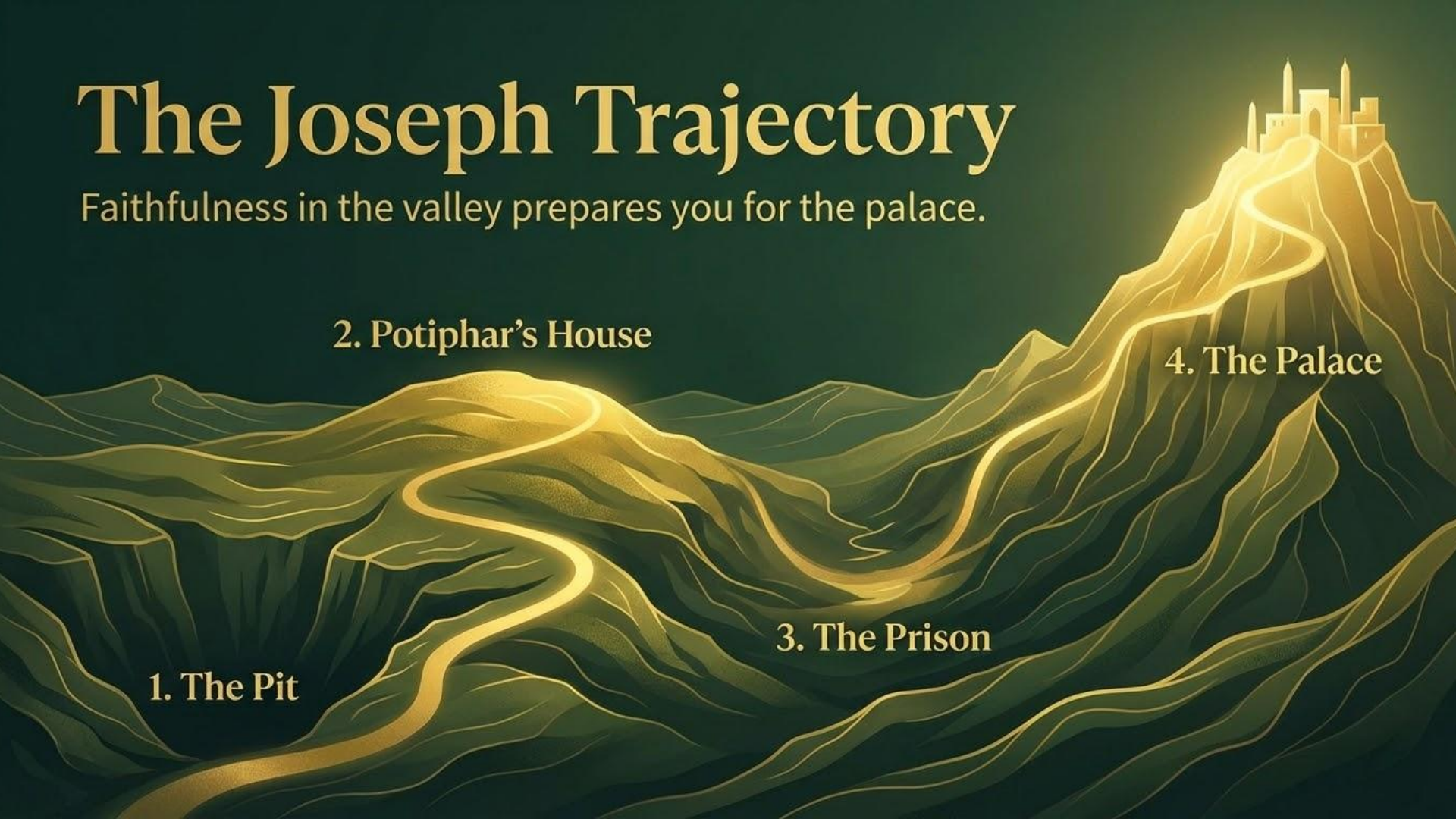
Before the Fall, there was the Garden.

Genesis 2:15 (ESV)

The Lord God took the man and put him in the garden of Eden to work it and keep it.

The Joseph Trajectory

Faithfulness in the valley prepares you for the palace.



Retirement

Moving from “Paid Vocation” to “Kingdom Vocation”

The Pivot

Scarcity (Squeezing)

Growth (Planting)

Discussion

1. Squeezing vs. Planting?
2. Prison or Palace?
3. The Owner’s Representative?

Questions?

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Next Steps

The Challenge: Do one disliked task this week with "Joseph-like" excellence.

Prayer: Read the Daily Scripture Prompts (Mon-Fri).
Monday: Colossians 3:23
Tuesday: Proverbs 16:3
Wednesday: Psalms 90:17
Thursday: 1 Corinthians 15:58
Friday: Ephesians 2:10